Rex W. Sitti

Assistant Professor of Economics • Old Dominion University
5115 Hampton Boulevard, Constant Hall 2033, Norfolk, VA 23529
rsitti@odu.edu | sites.google.com/view/rexwsitti

Education

Ph.D., Economics | The University of New Mexico 2024
Dissertation: Essays on the Societal Impacts of Housing and Substance Use Disorder Treatment Programs

M.A., Economics | The University of New Mexico 2019

M.B.A., International Business | The University of Memphis 2015

B.Com., Finance and Accounting | Kenyatta University 2011

Research focus: Urban Economics • Housing • Health Economics • Substance Use Disorders • Program Evaluation • Hedonic Analysis • Spatial Econometrics • Neighborhood Effects

Publications & Research

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- **Sitti, R.W.**, Saavedra, J.L., Crisanti, A.S., & Horn, B.P. (2025). "A cost analysis of a peer support-driven intervention for substance use disorders." *American Journal of Drug and Alcohol Abuse*, 51(6). doi:10.1080/00952990.2025.2585900 SJR: 0.970 (Q1)
- **Sitti, R.W.**, Horn, B.P., Bonham, C., Kincaid, T., & Xiaoya, W. (forthcoming). "Are Increased Engagements with Recovery Support Services Associated with Reductions in Medicaid Billing Charges and Reimbursements?" *Health Services Research*. SJR: 1.757 (Q1); ABDC: A
- Dole, J.L., Crisanti, A.S., Page-Reeves, J., Horn, B.P., **Sitti, R.W.**, Schwartz, M.R., Lucero, A., & Perez, M. (2025). "A review of the literature on neighborhood impacts of permanent supportive housing (PSH) and emergency shelters for people experiencing homelessness." *Housing, Care and Support*, 28(2), 43–55. doi:10.1108/HCS-02-2024-0003 SJR: 0.208 (Q2)
- **Sitti, R.W.** & Berrens, R.P. (2022). "Valuing fishing access on Lake Victoria's Winam Gulf: A hedonic pricing model." *International Journal of Ecological Economics & Statistics*, 43(2). ceser.in

Submitted / Under Peer Review

- Wai Yan, S. & **Sitti, R.W.** "Coastal Flooding and Housing Market Liquidity." *Under review*, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management. SJR: 2.968 (Q1); ABDC: A*
- **Sitti, R.W.** "Does Reducing Homelessness Raise Housing Costs? Evidence from Built for Zero." *Under review*, Journal of Housing Economics. SJR: 0.768 (Q2); ABDC: A
- **Sitti, R.W.**, Horn, B., & Berrens, R.P. "The Effect of Homeless Shelters on Property Values: Evidence from Seattle, WA." *Submitted*, Real Estate Economics. SJR: 1.474 (Q1); ABDC: A
- **Sitti, R.W.** "Where a Refund Goes: State Earned Income Tax Credit Supplements and the Composition of Household Spending." *Submitted*, National Tax Journal. SJR: 1.232 (Q1); ABDC: A

Work in Progress

- **Sitti, R.W.**, Horn, B.P., & Li, X. "The Impact of Housing Support Services on Crime: Evidence from the Built-For-Zero Program." In preparation for submission to *Regional Science and Urban Economics*. SJR: 1.472 (Q1); ABDC: A
- Joshi, A. & **Sitti, R.W.** "The Effect of Homeless Shelters on Localized Crime: Evidence from Seattle, WA." In preparation for submission to *Journal of Urban Economics*. SJR: 2.957 (Q1); ABDC: A*
- **Sitti, R.W.** "Homeless Encampment Sweeps and Neighborhood Outcomes: Evidence from Seattle, Denver, and Los Angeles after *Grants Pass*." Targeted for *Journal of Urban Economics*. SJR: 2.957 (Q1); ABDC: A*
- **Sitti, R.W.** "State Public-Camping Bans and the Geography of Homelessness: Evidence from Continuum of Care Panels." Work in progress.
- Wai Yan, S. & **Sitti, R.W.** "Tidal Flooding, Historical Redlining, and Emergency Department Access." Work in progress (ODU IRAD-funded).

Other Research Activity

Co-PI | Economic and Community Impacts of Coastal Flooding and Environmental Exposure in Hampton Roads and Coastal Virginia — July 2026 – June 2027
ODU Internal Research and Development (IRAD), $74,000

Research Assistant | Dept. of Psychiatry and Behavioral Sciences, University of New Mexico — 2020 – 2024
Contributed to the SAMHSA-funded research, "Economic Evaluations of Contingency Management and Peer Support Services for Substance Use Disorders."

Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor | Department of Economics, Old Dominion University — 2024 – Present

Research Fellow | Dragas Center for Economic Analysis and Policy — 2024 – Present

Teaching Experience

Old Dominion University

- Econometrics II (ECON 707/807) — Spring 2026
- Mathematical Economics (ECON 625) — Fall 2026
- Managerial Economics (ECON 301) — Spring 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026
- Economics for Managers (ECON 510) — Fall 2025
- Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 201S) — Spring 2025
- Urban Economics (ECON 445W/545) — Fall 2024

University of New Mexico

- Intermediate Macroeconomics (ECON 303) — Fall 2023
- Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 2120) — Spring 2023
- Econometrics II (Lab Instructor, ECON 309) — Spring 2019
- Graduate Teaching Assistant: Game Theory (Spring 2020), Consumer Economics (Fall 2019), Economics of Race and Gender (Spring 2019), Introductory Microeconomics (Fall 2018)

Other Teaching Experience

- Advanced Research Methods (Teaching Fellow, ECOG 315), Michigan State University — Summer 2020
- Financial Management (Graduate TA, FIR 3410), University of Memphis — 2014–2015

Professional Experience

- Accounts Receivable Specialist, Cummins Mid-South, USA — 2015 – 2016
- Customer Service & Finance Lab Graduate Assistant, University of Memphis — 2013 – 2015

Conferences & Presentations

- St. Lawrence University, Canton, NY — invited talk — October 2025
- E.V. Williams Center for Real Estate Annual Symposium (ODU) — October 2025
- Southern Economic Association Conference, Washington, DC — November 2022–2025
- Midwest Economic Association Annual Conference, Columbus, OH — March 2023
- American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference — June 2022
- NBER Behavioral Public Economics Boot Camp — May 2022
- Himalayan Policy Research Conference — July 2021
- Annual Department of Psychiatry Research Showcase — November 2020
- New Mexico Public Health Association Conference — April 2019

Honors & Awards

- ODU Internal Research and Development (IRAD) Award (Co-PI), Old Dominion University Research Foundation, $74,000 — 2026–2027
- E.V. Williams Center for Real Estate Seed Grant Program, $5,000 — 2025
- ODU Early Career Research Academy — 2025
- Southern Economic Association Travel Award — 2023
- Michelle Elizabeth Canaday Memorial Endowed Scholarship — 2023
- Doctoral Conference Presentation Award — 2022
- Departmental Three Minutes Research Competition Award — 2020
- Outstanding Research Award, Michigan State University & AEASP — 2020
- J. Raymond Stuart Award in Economics — 2020

Service & Affiliations

- Member, Faculty and Recruitment Committee, Strome College of Business — 2025 – Present
- Faculty Advisor, The SUMMIT ODU (student-led undergraduate organization) — 2026 – Present
- Mentor, MA Graduate Students, Old Dominion University — 2024 – Present
- Discussant, E.V. Williams Center for Real Estate Annual Symposium (ODU) — 2025
- Ad hoc Reviewer, *Journal of Urban Affairs* — 2026
- Ad hoc Reviewer, *Frontiers in Remote Sensing* — 2026

- Mentor, Project for New Mexico Graduates of Color (PNMGC), UNM 2019 – 2023
- Treasurer, Economics Graduate Students Organization (EGSO), UNM 2020 – 2021
- Reviewer, Undergraduate Research Opportunity Conference, UNM 2019

Professional memberships: American Economic Association; American Society of Health Economists; Western Economic Association International; Midwest Economic Association

Technical Skills

- **Statistical software:** R (expert), Stata (proficient), SAS (intermediate), SPSS (proficient)
- **Data visualization:** Tableau (proficient), GIS (proficient)
- **Programming:** Python (basic)

References

Available upon request.